

The State of the Church - May 4, 2025

I. Welcome!

If you are a first-time guest or you are wanting to plug in more to weekly virtual prayer meetings, our Wednesday night small groups, serving, or membership—*Fill out our digital connect card to stay connected!*



II. Announcements

1. Virtual Prayer starts up this week! Join us for a 45-min curated time of prayer!

Mornings (Mon-Fri): 7:30-8:15 am

Afternoons (Fri): 12:15-1:00 pm

Evenings (Mon, Tues, Thurs): 8:15-9:00 pm

2. Our next 8-week cycle of Small Groups begins this Wednesday! Sign up with Hannah at the Connections table.

3. New sermon series, “Conversations” starts next week!

III. Message: Living Christ-formed on Mission

I. Part 1: Finance and Serving: A people-centered Church

Key Highlights:

- Transparency builds trust—we aim to steward both people and finances faithfully.
- Giving Snapshot:
 - 221 Total Donors | 165 YTD Donors | \$194,709.12 YTD Giving
 - Avg. Monthly Giving: \$20,000
 - 70% of Members Give | Gifts cover ~50% of budget
- Serving Culture:
 - Every role—from hospitality to prayer teams—builds a spiritual family.
 - GateCity Kids is thriving: children are encountering God, worshiping, and growing in truth.
- Giving Liturgy:
 - Giving is a sacred, joyful act of worship—not just necessity.
 - Hannah shares liturgy to invite heartfelt generosity

II. Part 2— Events & Spiritual Curation — Conversations, Prayer, Pentecost

Key Highlights:

- **Transformed Series Recap**
 - Blogs, podcast, prayer guides, formation nights

- Current weekly prayer focus: "Our Church & the City"
- **New Series: Conversations** (Starts next week)
 - Includes co-authored book, prayer guide, blogs, and podcast
 - Focus on spiritual dialogue with God and authentic relationships
- **Pentecost ATL — June 8**
 - Multi-church gathering (Lawrenceville, City Takers, United Church)
 - Outdoor worship & unity event
 - Register at PentecostATL.com + Share social invites

III. Part 3 – Vision – Christ Formed Lives on Mission

What Is the Church?

- Bonhoeffer: "Christianity means community through Jesus Christ."
- The Church is not built on human leadership—but on Christ as the foundation (1 Cor. 3:11).

Mentor Story: The Outcome of Discipleship

- What is the desired outcome: relief or transformation?
- Discipleship aims at *Christlikeness* — "For those God foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters." (Romans 8:29)
- Galatians 4:19: "My dear children, for whom I am again in the pains of childbirth until Christ is formed in you."

Christ Formed Vision Map: The 5-4-3-2-1

5 Behaviors

- Pray – Matthew 6:6
- Give – Matthew 6:3–4
- Serve – Matthew 5:16
- Form – Matthew 28:19–20
- Reach – Mark 16:15

4 Spaces

- Altar (Worship) – 1 Peter 2:9
- Table (Community) – Ephesians 2:19
- Road (Mission) – Romans 10:15
- Love (Motivation) – 1 Corinthians 14:1

3 Promises

- Healthy Today – 2 Peter 1:3
- Fruitful Life – John 10:10
- Eternal Reward – Matthew 25:21

2 Distinctives

- Reaching the Unreached
- Day & Night Prayer

1 Mission: To live Christ-formed lives on mission.

- Matthew 16:16–18: "Upon this rock I will build my Church."
- 1 Cor. 3:10–11: Build carefully on the foundation of Jesus.
- Formation is always *for the sake of others* (Ruth Haley Barton, Mulholland)